

Tool 6 · Funding Application Checklist

Sustainable SME Toolkit · Nigeria

Most SME funding applications in Nigeria fail not because the business is unfundable, but because the application is incomplete, internally inconsistent, or missing documents the lender asked for in the small print. This checklist consolidates what BoI, DBN, SMEDAN, CBN intervention windows, and commercial banks typically ask for.

Work through each section in order. Tick each item as you confirm it is ready. Items with higher weight (3) are the ones most likely to cause rejection if missing or weak. Press Submit at the bottom to email your completed checklist to DIT for review before you submit to a lender.

READINESS SCORE Max possible: 76 %	STATUS Updates as you tick boxes 	Submit	Reset
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#	Item	Wt	Done	Evidence / notes
1	CAC registration certificate (Form CAC 1.1 or equivalent)	3		
2	Memorandum and Articles of Association (MEMART)	2		
3	FIRS Tax Identification Number (TIN) certificate	3		
4	Tax Clearance Certificate (TCC) for the last 3 years	3		
5	VAT registration certificate (if turnover above threshold)	2		
6	Directors' / owner's valid ID (NIN, Driver's Licence, International Passport, Voter's Card)	2		
7	Utility bill (proof of business address, not older than 3 months)	2		
8	Bank statements for the last 12 months (corporate account)	3		
9	Bank reference letter from your corporate bank	1		
10	Resolution of the board (or owner's consent) to borrow	2		
1	Executive summary (1–2 pages)	2		
2	Business description and history	1		
3	Product or service description	2		
4	Market analysis (target customers, competitors, size)	2		
5	Marketing and sales strategy	2		
6	Operations plan (location, capacity, suppliers, processes)	2		
7	Management team and key staff	2		
8	SWOT or risk analysis with mitigations	1		

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#	Item	Wt	Done	Evidence / notes
9	3-year financial projections (P&L, cash flow, balance sheet)	3		
10	Use of funds breakdown (itemised, with quotes where possible)	3		
11	Repayment plan showing how cash flow covers principal and interest	3		
1	Audited financial statements for the last 2–3 years	3		
2	Management accounts for the current year (monthly)	2		
3	Bank statements reconciled with financial statements	3		
4	Tax filings reconciled with financial statements	2		
5	Aged debtors and creditors report	2		
6	Inventory valuation report	1		
7	Fixed asset register with proof of ownership	2		
8	Customer contracts or purchase orders	2		
1	Energy audit report (kWh baseline + diesel litres baseline)	3		
2	Solar system design and vendor quote (for solar loans)	3		
3	Projected energy savings and payback calculation	2		
4	NESREA compliance certificate or environmental impact assessment	2		
5	Sustainability KPI tracker (last 6–12 months)	1		
6	Brief sustainability policy (1 page)	1		
7	Carbon footprint estimate (annual)	1		

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Top 8 Reasons SME Applications Get Rejected

- Incomplete or missing documents listed in the small print of the application
- CAC registration details that do not match the operating address
- Financial statements that do not tie out to bank statements
- Business plan with unrealistic revenue projections (no sensitivity analysis)
- No clear use-of-funds breakdown
- Existing debt obligations not disclosed
- No collateral or personal guarantee documented
- Sustainability / ESG claims with no evidence or baseline data

Where to Apply — Nigerian SME Funder Directory

BoI	Bank of Industry — long-term loans, secured, from N5m up. boi.ng
DBN	Development Bank of Nigeria — wholesale loans via PFIs. dbn.ng
SMEDAN	Small & Medium Enterprises Development Agency — grants, training. smedan.gov.ng
CBN	Central Bank intervention windows (e.g. AGSMEIS, TCF). cbn.gov.ng
Commercial banks	Stanbic IBTC, Access, Zenith, GTB — SME banking packages
State agencies	LSETF (Lagos), YAEDA (Kano), etc. — vary by state

STATUS TIER LEGEND

☐ NOT STARTED (0%)
 ☐ EARLY STAGE (<40%)
 ☐ IN PROGRESS (40-69%)
 ☐ ALMOST READY (70-89%)
 ☐ READY TO APPLY (90-100%)

Tick each item as you confirm it is ready. Items with weight 3 are most likely to cause rejection if missing.